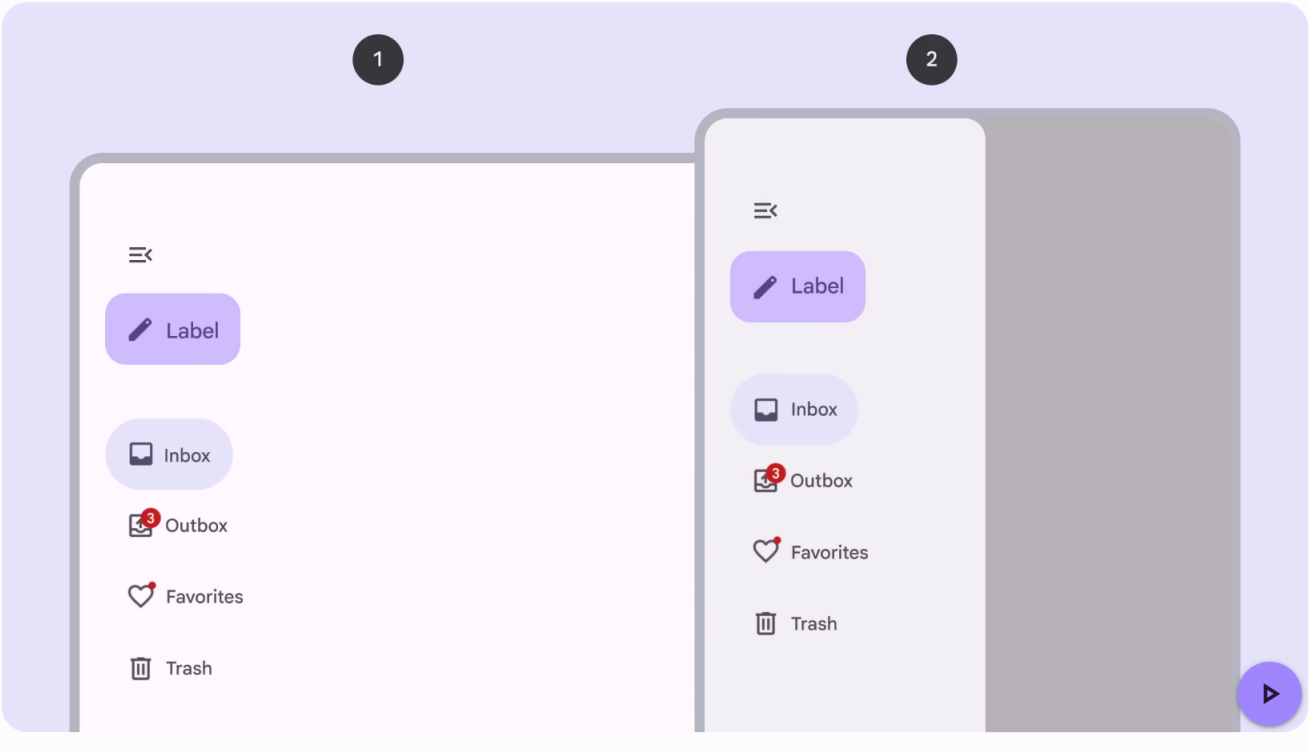
Navigation rail

Navigation rails let people switch between UI views on mid-sized devices

Resources +3

- Use navigation rails in medium, expanded, large, or extra-large window sizes
- Can contain 3-7 destinations plus an optional FAB
- Always put the rail in the same place, even on different screens of an app



Collapsed and expanded navigation rails can transition between each other on any device, including:

1. Large or medium window size classes like tablets
2. Compact window size classes like phones in portrait orientation

M3 Expressive update

May 2025

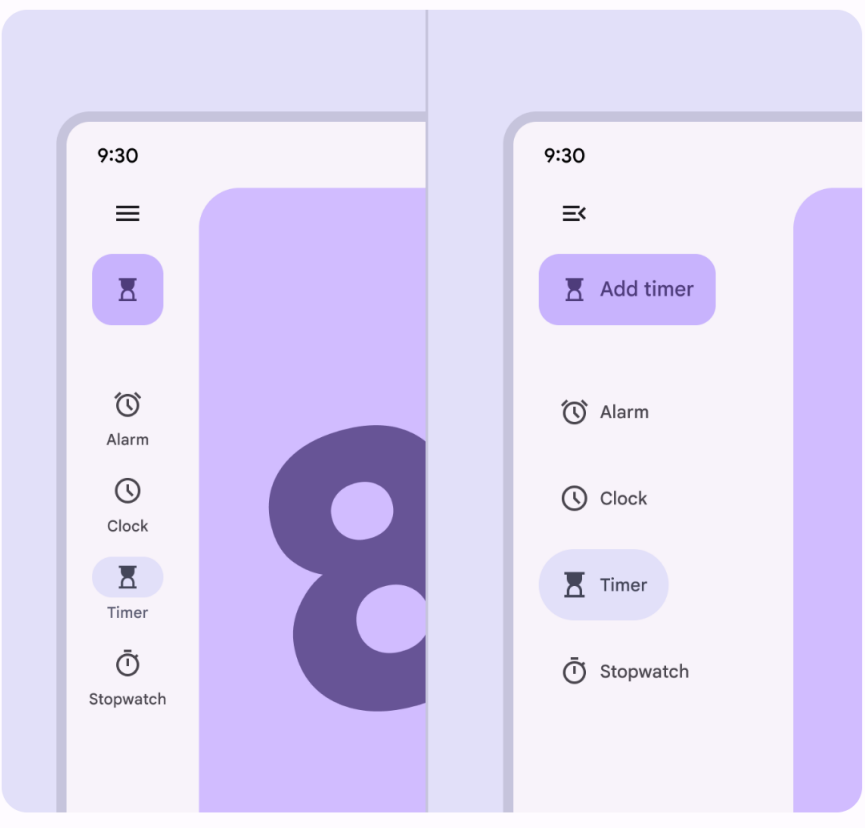
A **collapsed** and **expanded** navigation rail have been introduced to replace the baseline nav rail. The expanded nav rail is meant to replace the navigation drawer. More on M3 Expressive

Variants and naming:

- The baseline **navigation rail** is no longer recommended
- Added two wider navigation rails:
  - **Collapsed:** replaces baseline nav rail
  - **Expanded**: replaces navigation drawer

Configurations:

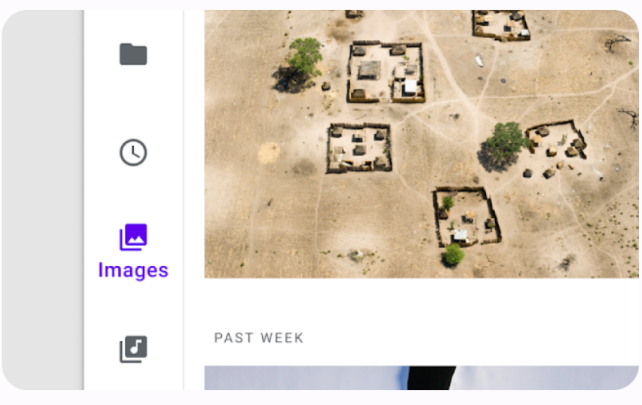
- Expanded rail modality:
  - Non-modal
  - Modal
- Expanded behavior:
  - Transition to collapsed navigation rail
  - Hide when collapsed
- Color:
  - Active label on vertical items changed from **on surface variant** to **secondary**



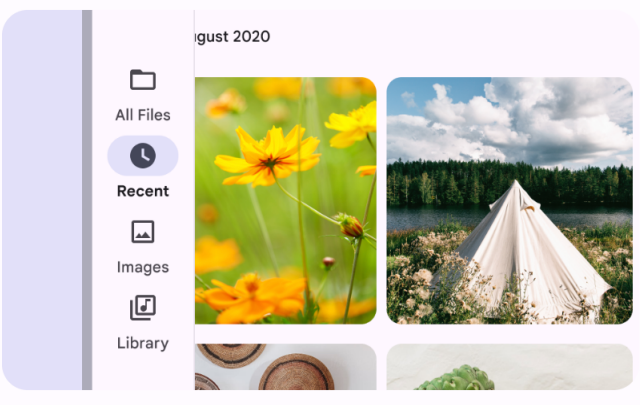
The collapsed and expanded navigation rails match visually and can transition into each other

Differences from M2

- Behavior: Predictive back interaction
- Color: New color mappings and compatibility with dynamic color
- States: The active destination can be indicated with a pill shape in a contrasting color



M2: The navigation rail uses icon color, weight, and fill to communicate which destination is active



M3: The navigation rail uses a pill-shaped active indicator to communicate which destination is active